

Social anxiety disorder

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The defining feature of social anxiety disorder (SAD) is the fear of negative evaluation by others. Therefore, SAD is directly linked to social standards and role expectations, which are culture dependent. (Hofmann, Asnaani, & Hinton, 2010).

Patients with SAD were generally characterized by a high percentage of males in clinical samples, early onset of the disorder, high education levels, and high comorbidity rates. (Hofmann, Asnaani, & Hinton, 2010).

One study reported that 92% of a sample of adults with social anxiety disorder reported a history of severe teasing in childhood. (Spielman et al., 2020).

Risk Factors for Disorder

The 2001–2002 National Epidemiologic Survey on Alcohol and Related Conditions (N 5 43,093) showed that being Native American, being young, and having low income increased the risk for developing this disorder, whereas being male, being of Asian, Hispanic, or black race/ethnicity, or living in urban or more populated regions reduced this risk. (Hofmann, Asnaani, & Hinton, 2010).



Signs/symptoms

Individuals with social anxiety disorder are typically shy when meeting new people, quiet in groups, and withdrawn in unfamiliar social settings. When they interact with others, they might or might not show overt evidence of discomfort (eg, blushing, not making eye contact), but invariably experience intense emotional or physical symptoms, or both (eg, fear, heart racing, sweating, trembling, trouble concentrating). (Stein & Stein, 2008)

(Guy-Evans, 2023)

Causes for Disorder

The causes and pathogenesis of social anxiety disorder are not well elucidated, but progress is being made. In the only reported genome-wide linkage analysis for social phobia, chromosome 16 seemed to be implicated, in a region proximate to a candidate gene, the norepinephrine transporter. (Stein & Stein, 2008)

Resources for therapy and/ or treatment of Disorder



(Healing Mind Psychiatry, 2024)

On Campus	King County:	State	National
Websites: • https://www.lwtech.edu/students/mental-health-counseling/index.aspx • https://app.timelycare.com/auth/login	• Phone: 206-263-8997 or 1-800-790-8049. • Website: https://www.psychologytoday.com/us/therapists/wa/king-county?category=hispanic-and-latino	• Website: https://www.dshs.wa.gov/esa/social-services-manual/mental-health-services • Spanish support: https://wa211.org/es/recursos/consejos-recursos-de-ayuda-para-salud-mental-residentes-de-washington/	• Phone: 1-301-443-5636 OR 1-800-662-4357 • Website: https://www.usa.gov/es/problemas-salud-mental#:~:text=Los%20centros%20de%20salud%20y%20los%20centros,mental%20(en%20ingl%C3%A9s)%20o%20llame%20al%201%2D800%2D662%2D4357.

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